

HARDWARE

Radar



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All that's new on the block—Bravish LCD monitor, Iomega Zip drive, ASUS TUA 266 motherboard and more

Not too hot

Sporting the Socket 370 interface, this processor comes with a heatsink alone and no fan. It uses the 0.13-micron technology, which consumes little power (between 7 to 14 Watts) and heats up considerably lesser than other processors in its range. It's targeted at the budget-conscious buyer not looking for top-of-the-class performance.

VIA C3 800 MHz



SPECIFICATIONS:

128 KB of L1 cache, 64 KB of L2 cache, 0.13-micron technology
Benchmarks:
SiSoft Sandra: 953 Mflops in CPU Whetstones, 1635 MIPS in CPU Dhrystones; 7 minutes 18 seconds for video encoding; 2 minutes 49 seconds for audio encoding; 64.6 fps (normal mode), 63.9 fps (high quality) and 58.8 fps (max settings) in Quake III; 499.17 seconds in the Photoshop test; 19.4 units in Content Creation

verdict

B

VIA C3 800 MHz

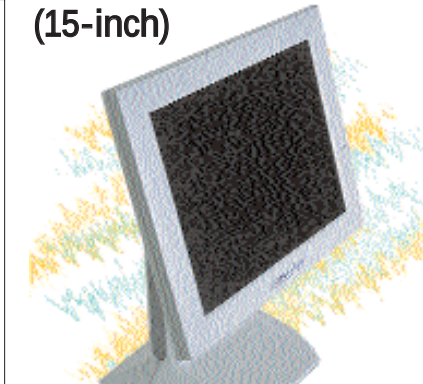
Performance	▲▲▲▲▲
Build Quality	▲▲▲▲▲
Value for Money	▲▲▲▲▲
Features	▲▲▲▲▲
OVERALL	▲▲▲▲▲

+ Does not require a heatsink; Good performance in day-to-day applications
- Comparatively high-priced
Price: Rs 4,000+taxes
Contact: eSys Distribution Ltd
Phone: 011-6420450
Fax: 011-6420431-52
E-mail: c3sales@esysmail.com

Lavish and sleek

This stylish 15-inch monitor features an easy-to-use onscreen display and offers flicker-free display even at the highest resolution. Installation is simple due to the plug and play feature. It occupies very little desktop space and can even be swivelled through 360 degrees. The featured pivot makes switching between horizontal or vertical display simple.

Bravish LCD Monitor (15-inch)



SPECIFICATIONS:

Supports a maximum resolution of 1024x768
Features: Average dot pitch of 0.30 mm, includes 1built-in multimedia speakers

verdict

B +

Bravish LCD monitor (15-inch)

Performance	▲▲▲▲▲
Build Quality	▲▲▲▲▲
Value for Money	▲▲▲▲▲
Ease of use	▲▲▲▲▲
OVERALL	▲▲▲▲▲

+ Stylish design
+ Uses little desktop space
- Tricky placement of OSD buttons
Price: Rs 35,000
Contact: Wales Technologies
Phone: 022-3828100 **Fax:** 022-3877418
E-mail: mediaman@bom3.vsnl.net.in
Web site: www.walestechnologies.com

An expensive proposition

This socket 370-based motherboard features five PCI slots and an AGP Pro slot, which guarantees you high-bandwidth game-play when coupled with a high-end 3D card. It provides you with four USB slots, so connecting USB devices to it is no problem. The board is a good buy as it supports both SDR and DDR RAM up to 3 GB.

ASUS TUA 266 Motherboard



SPECIFICATIONS:

Supports the P-III Coppermine and Tualatin (0.13 micron) processors; ALi M1651 north bridge and the ALi M1535+ south bridge chipsets; DDR RAM compatible; five PCI slots; four USB ports
Interface: Socket 370
Benchmarks: 1619 in 3D Mark 2001; 15687 in SiSoft Sandra; 23 MBps sequential read; 4 MBps random read; 20 MBps sequential write; 5 MBps random write; 26.3 in Content Creation

verdict

B -

ASUS TUA 266 Motherboard

Performance	▲▲▲▲▲
Build Quality	▲▲▲▲▲
Value for Money	▲▲▲▲▲
Features	▲▲▲▲▲
OVERALL	▲▲▲▲▲

+ Five PCI slots; Support for up to 3 GB DDR RAM/SD RAM
- High price
Price: Rs 9,500
Contact: Rashi Peripherals.
Phone: 022- 8260258 **Fax:** 022- 8221012
E-mail: ho@rptechindia.com
Web site: www.rptechindia.com